# STRING OF SUCCESSES

**JYOTHI SUREKHA VENNAM, 30**

**Sport: *ARCHERY***

**Discipline**

**Archery (Compound)**

**Claim to fame**

**India's most decorated woman compound archer with over 90 international medals, including a historic triple gold at the 2022 Asian Games; world ranked #4**

**When Jyothi Surekha Vennam heads** to Nagoya, it will be her fourth run in the Asian Games squad. She has five medals in the competition to show for her efforts, but it's not just her ability to make consistency seem like a cakewalk, it's her origins that make her story remarkable.

She had once hoped to be a swimmer. She took to the pool at three and earned several laurels, including a Limca Book of Records entry for crisscrossing the Krishna river thrice in 3 hours 20 mins. The shift to archery came when she was 11, when her father, a prawn farmer, found the swimming facilities in Vijayawada to be subpar. She says, "I am an only child and my parents' only desire is that I should shine in sports on the world stage."

The Vennam dream to excel in sports is an exception in Andhra Pradesh, where most parents and wards target IITs, IIMs and high-flying careers in




*Photograph by* **ARUN KUMAR**